

India's Health Landscape

Mortality, nutrition, human development and the gender gaps that run through all three.

4 CHAPTERS	19 INDICATORS	8 WITH STATE DATA	1961–2025 PERIOD COVERED
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Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 18 sources

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 19 indicators across 4 chapters, drawn from 18 sources and covering 1961–2025.

Of those indicators, 8 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India's states. The remaining 11 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

Coverage limits. This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 **Multidimensional poverty by state**

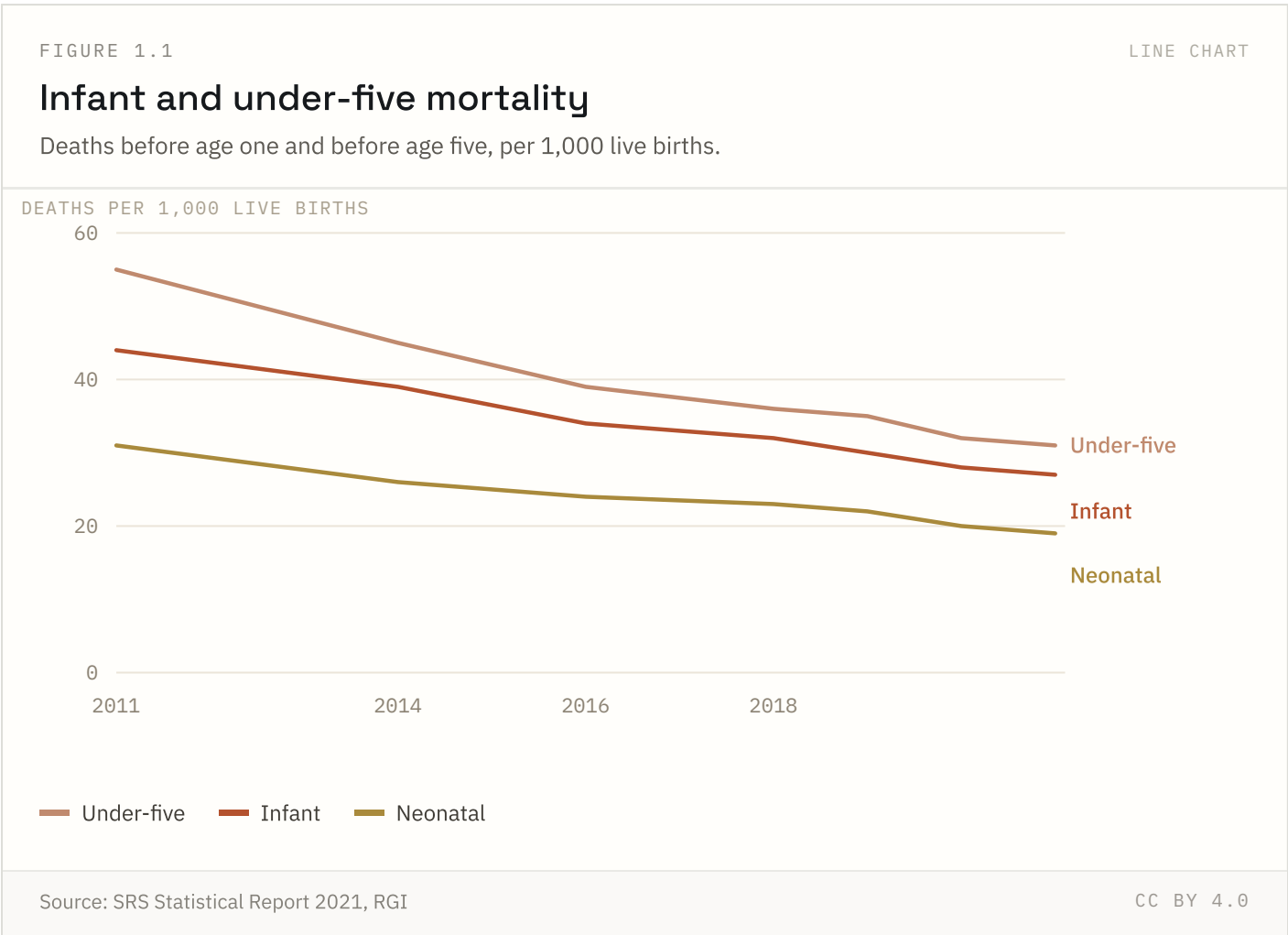
Ranges from 33.76% in Bihar to 0.55% in Kerala — a spread of 33.21% across the 25 states reported.

NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

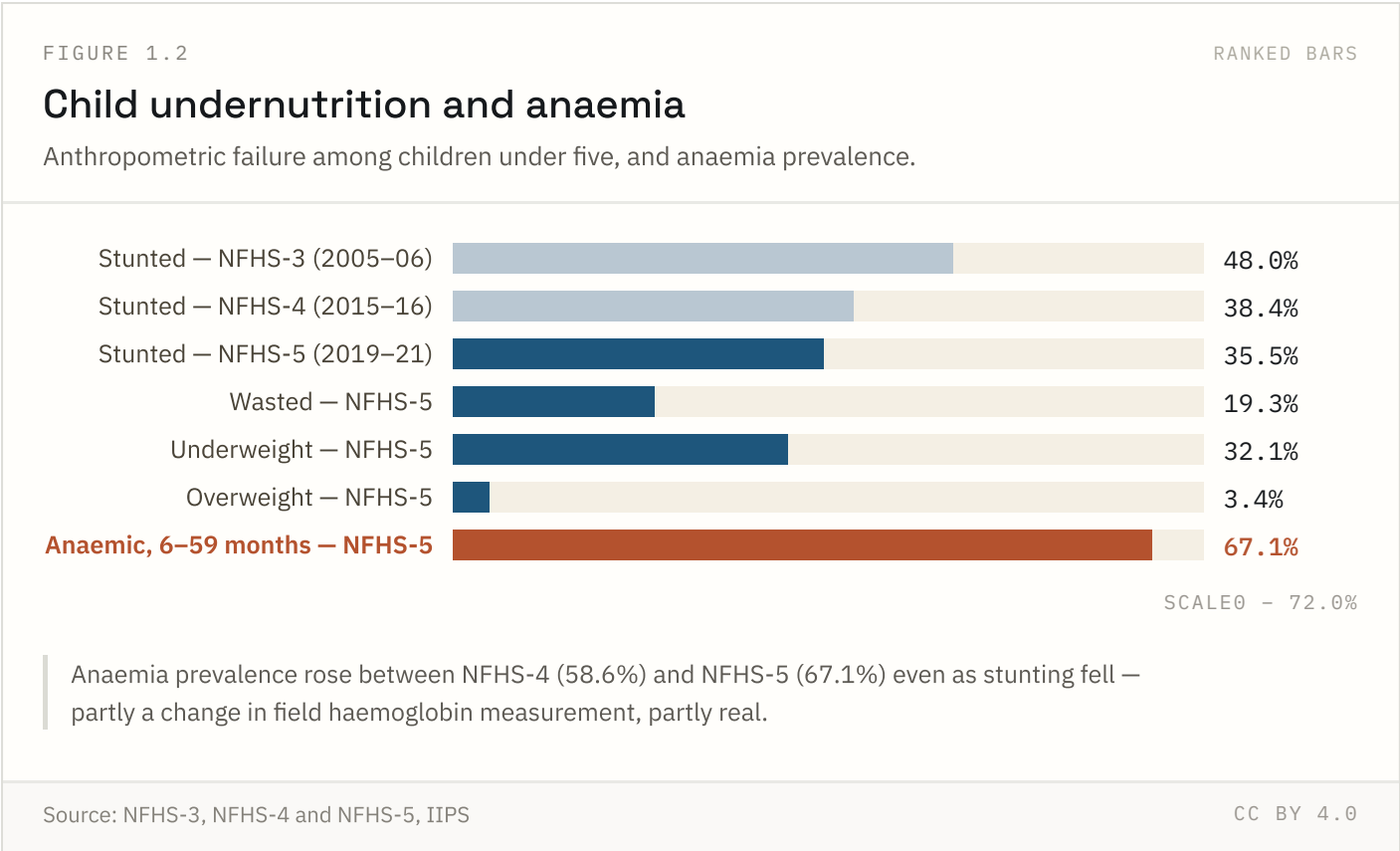
Health & nutrition

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL + STATE

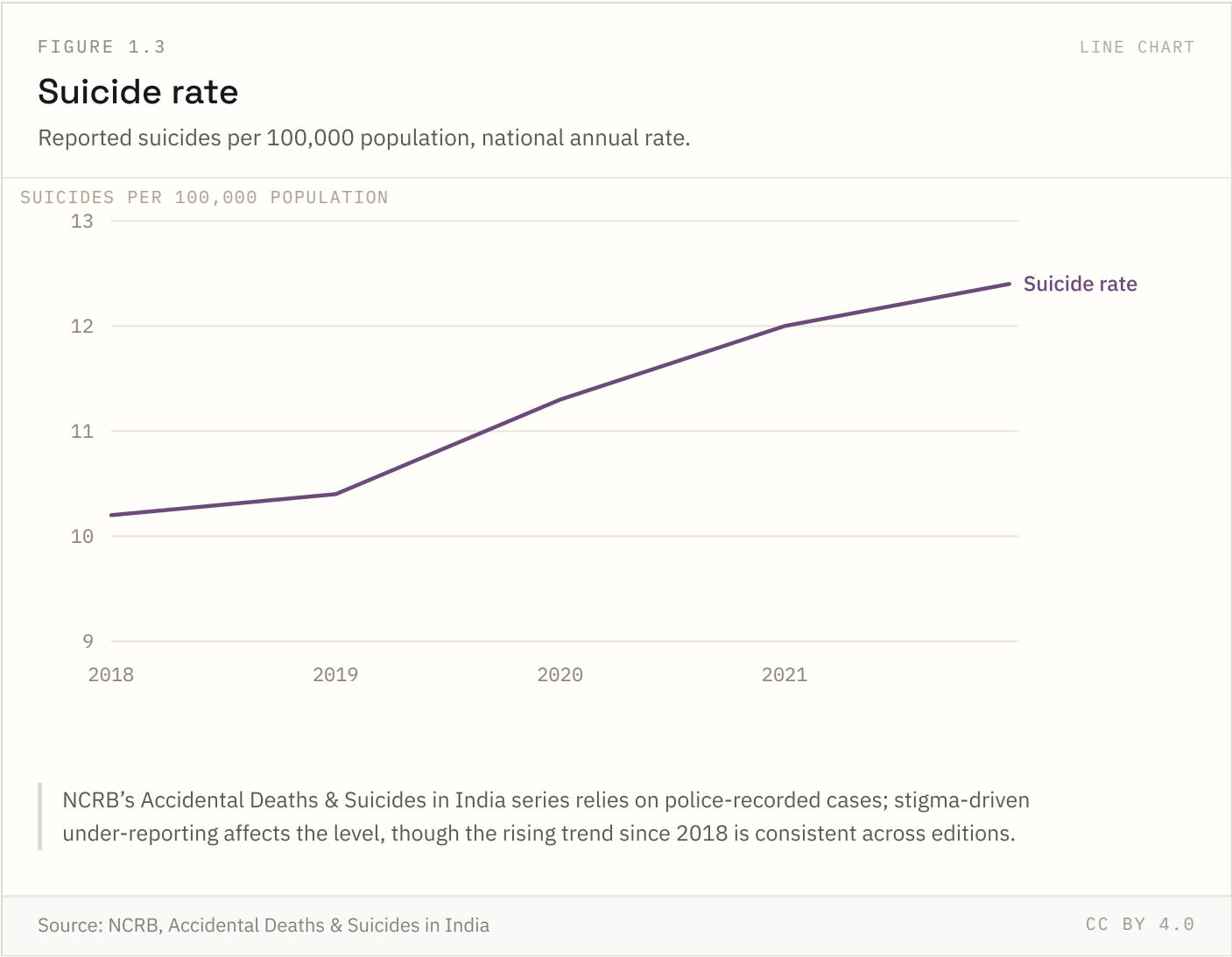


India accounted for roughly a fifth of global under-five deaths in 2022, down from a third in 1990. The decline is steepest in states that expanded institutional delivery fastest after 2005.



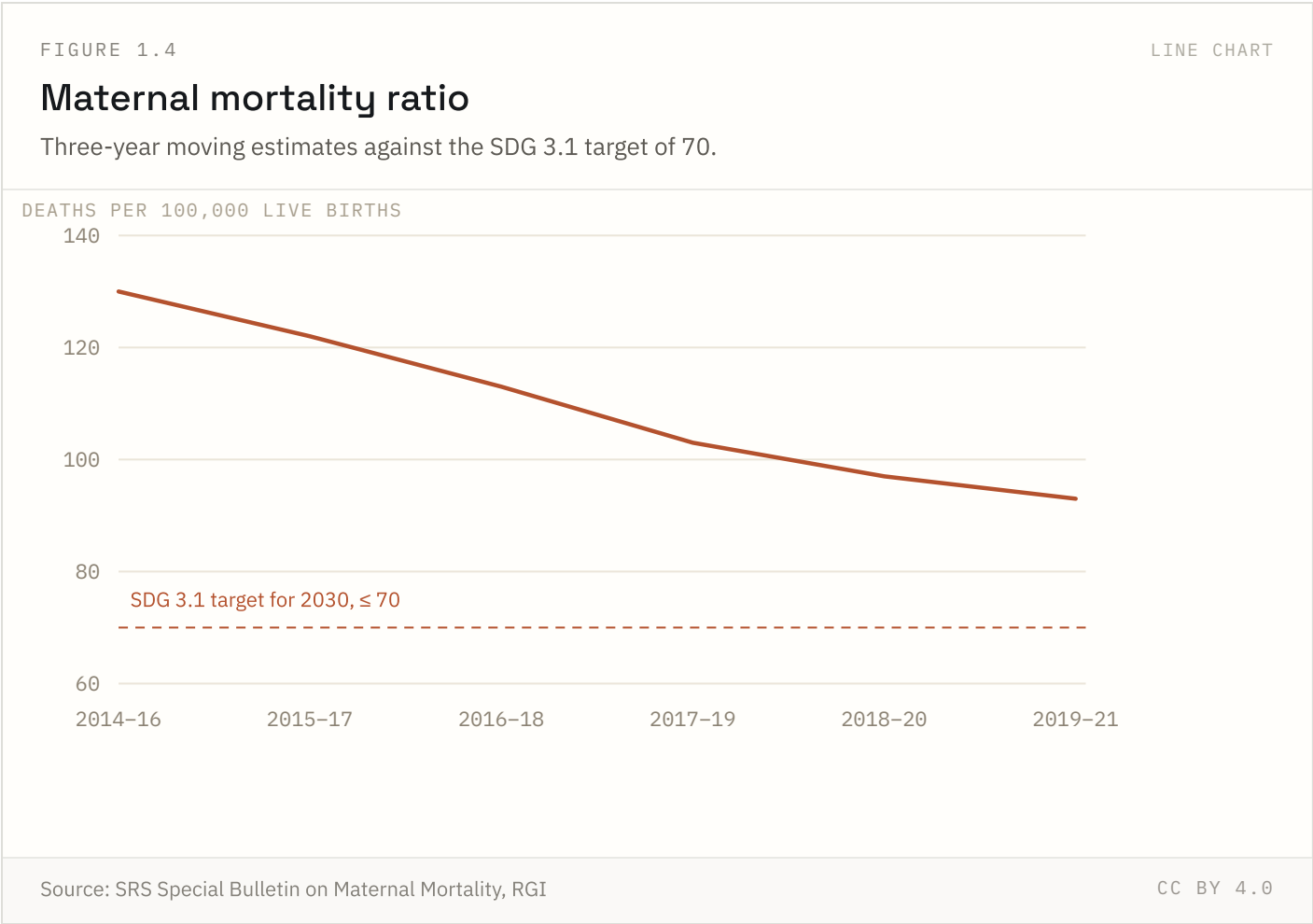
Stunting (low height-for-age) reflects chronic undernutrition; wasting (low weight-for-height) reflects acute deficits. Anaemia prevalence rose between NFHS-4 and NFHS-5 even as stunting fell — partly a measurement change, partly real.

FIGURE 1.3 NATIONAL ONLY



The rate has risen every year since 2018. NCRB figures are police-recorded cases; stigma and, until 2017, the criminal status of attempted suicide are known sources of under-reporting, so levels are likely understated even where the trend is real.

Source: NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India Coverage: 2018–2022 Updated: 18 Aug 2026



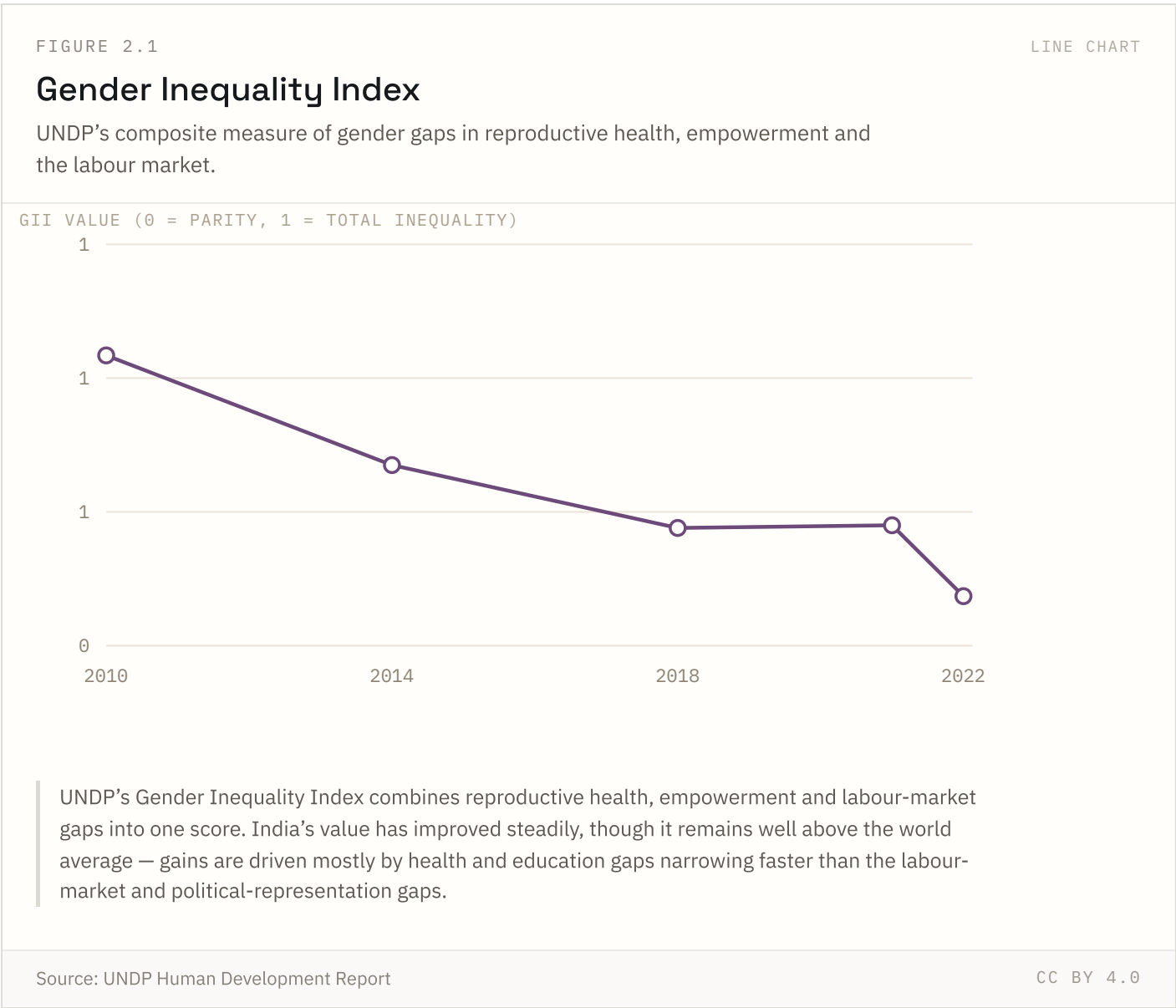
MMR fell from 130 in 2014–16 to 93 in 2019–21. Eight States have already met the SDG target; Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar remain furthest from it.

Source: SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI Coverage: 2014–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 02 Jun 2026

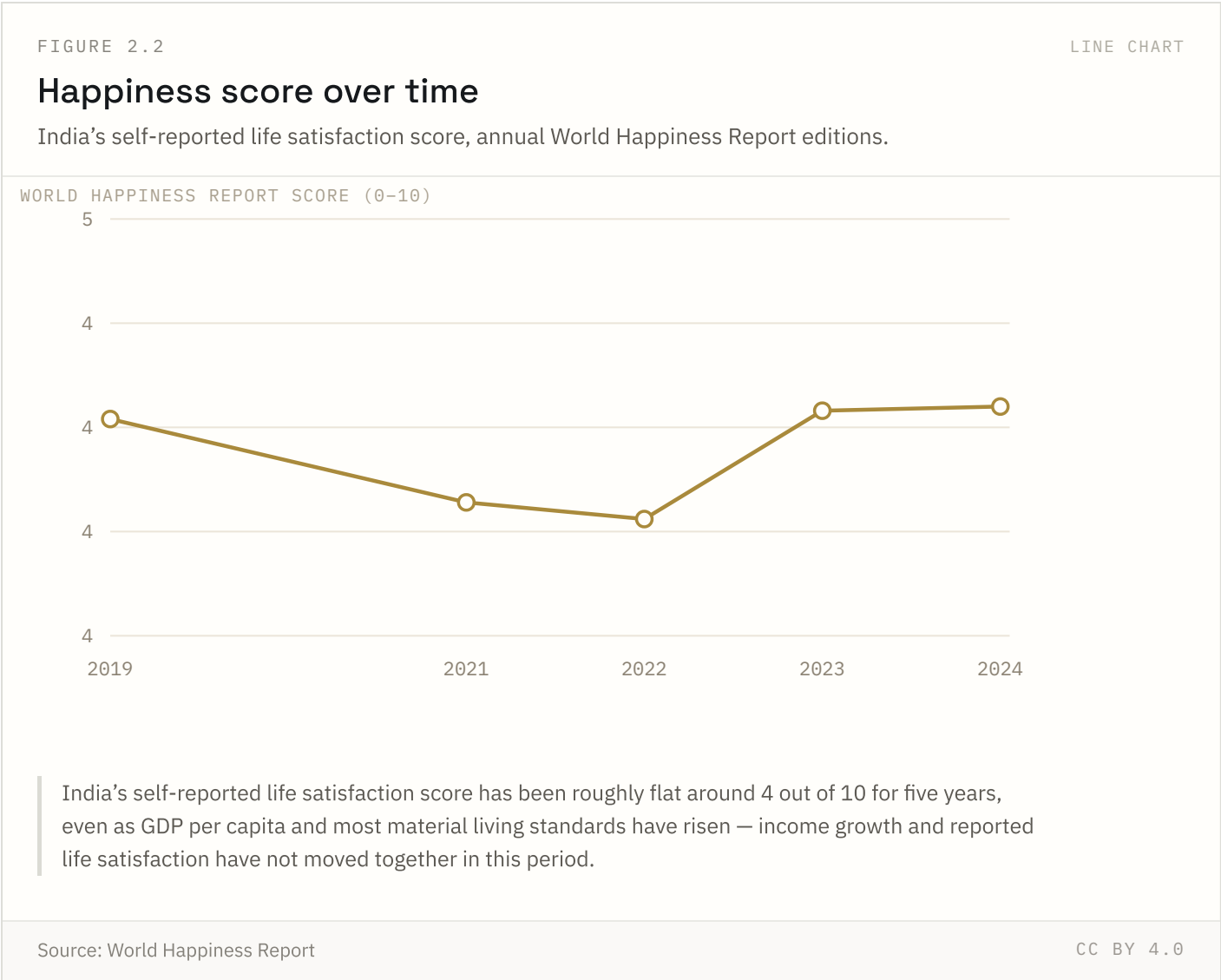
Human development & wellbeing

All 4 indicators in this chapter are published at national level only. No state breakdown is available from the sources used.

FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL ONLY

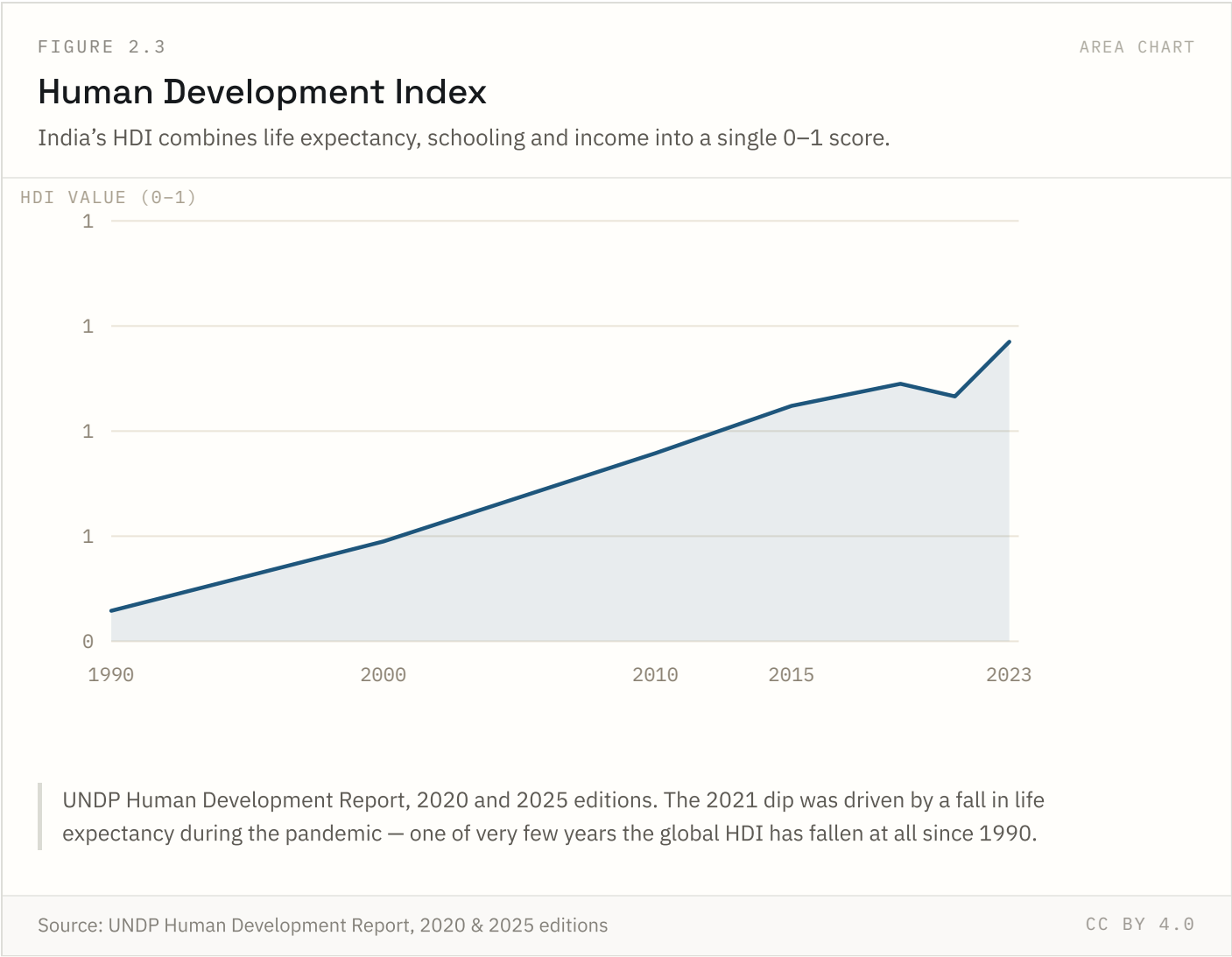


India's GII has improved steadily, mostly on faster progress in health and education than in labour-market participation and political representation — the index blends these into one score, so it can mask which underlying gap is moving and which is stuck.

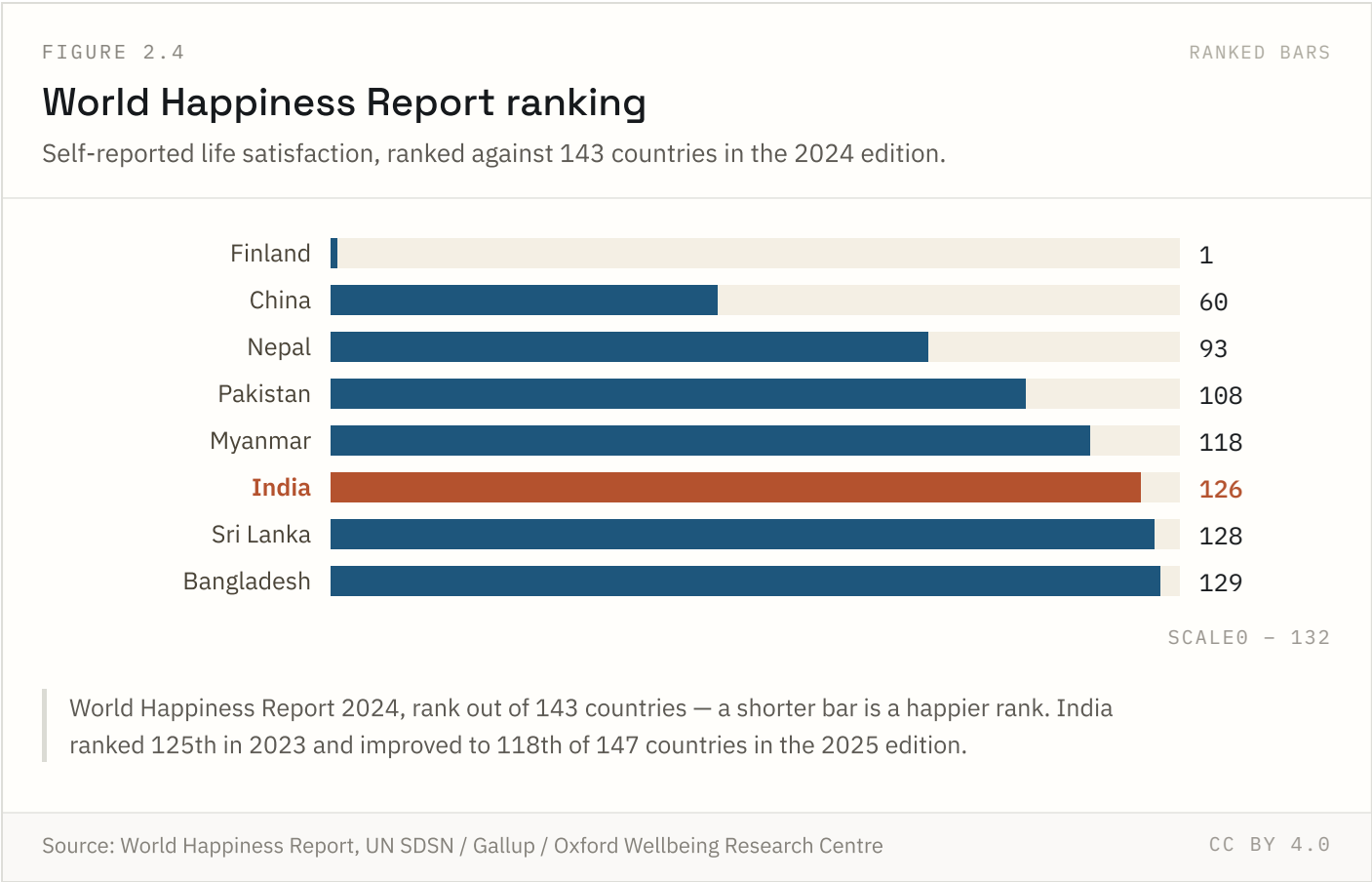


The score has stayed close to 4 out of 10 for five years even as GDP per capita and most material indicators in this dataset have risen — a reminder that self-reported wellbeing and income growth do not move in lockstep.

FIGURE 2.3 NATIONAL ONLY



India's HDI rose from 0.429 in 1990 to 0.645 in 2019, then fell for two straight years as life expectancy dropped during the pandemic — one of very few declines the global HDI has recorded since 1990. It recovered to 0.685 in 2023, ranking India 130th of 193 countries, still in the medium human-development band, just below the 0.700 threshold for 'high'.



India ranked 126th of 143 countries in 2024, behind China by 66 places and behind every neighbour shown except Bangladesh and Sri Lanka. The ranking is built from self-reported life satisfaction (the Cantril ladder) alongside GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and corruption perception — it measures reported wellbeing, not an objective standard of living. India improved to 118th of 147 countries in the 2025 edition.

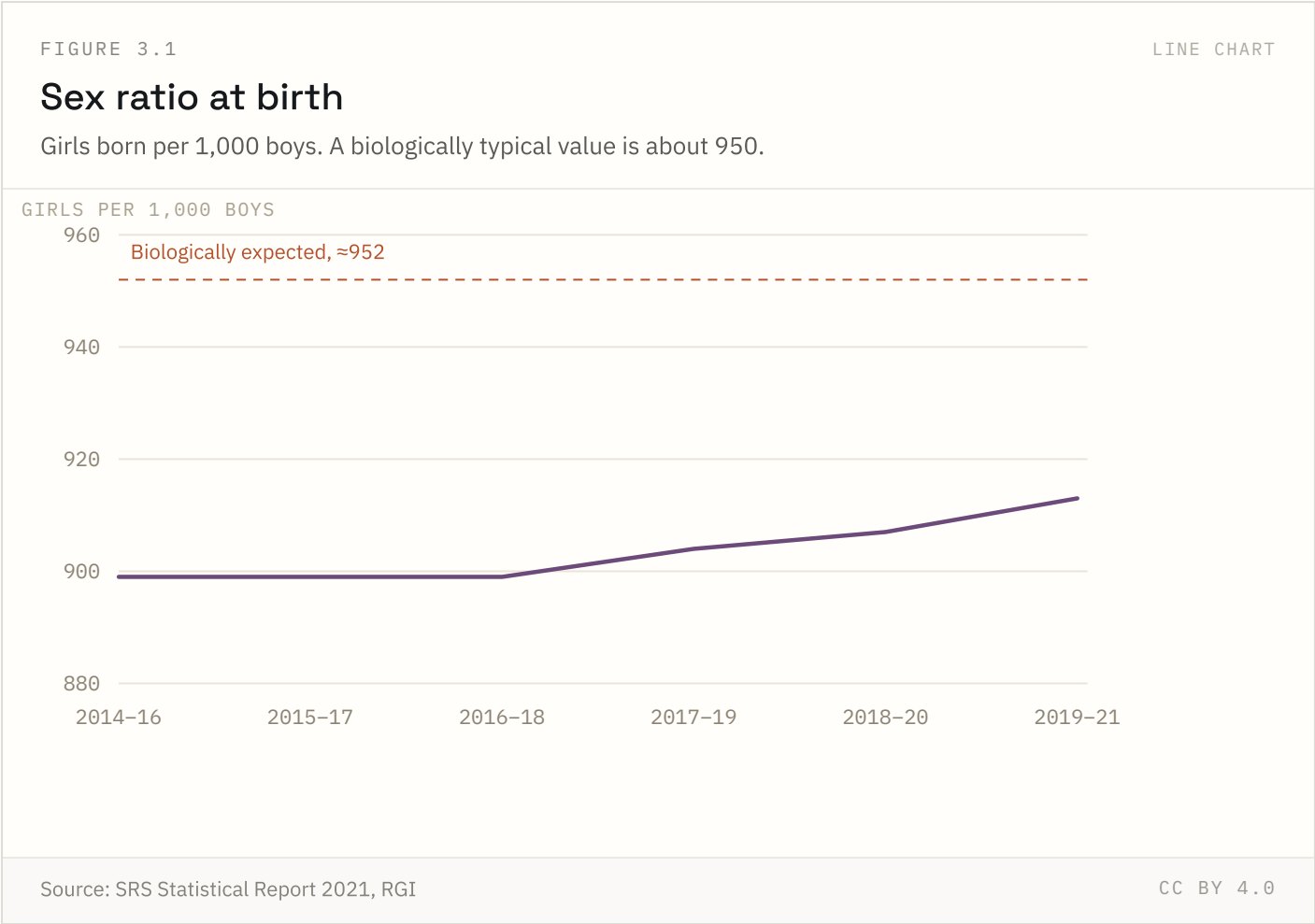
Source: World Happiness Report, UN SDSN / Gallup / Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre Coverage: 2024

Updated: 17 Aug 2026

Gender

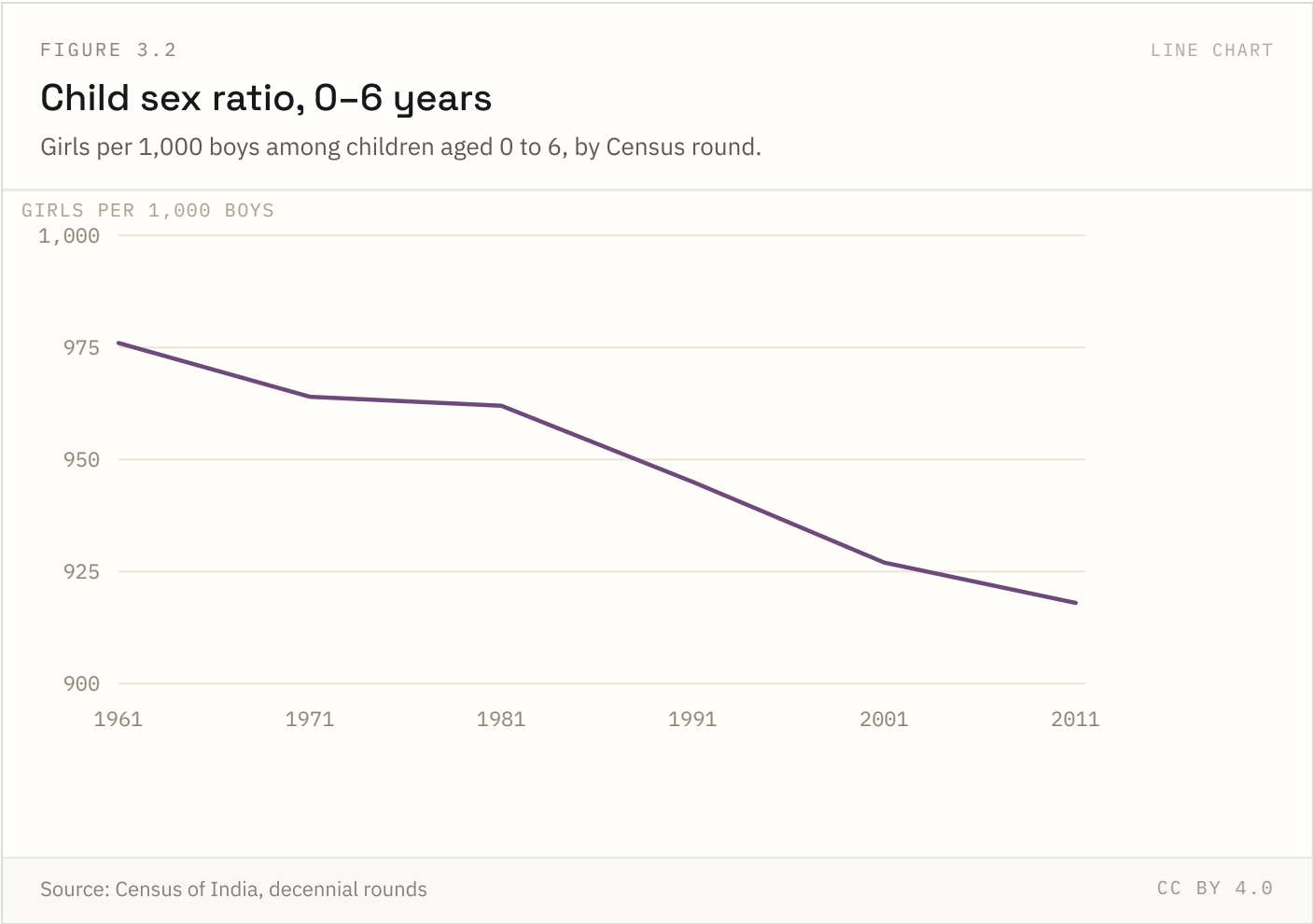
2 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE



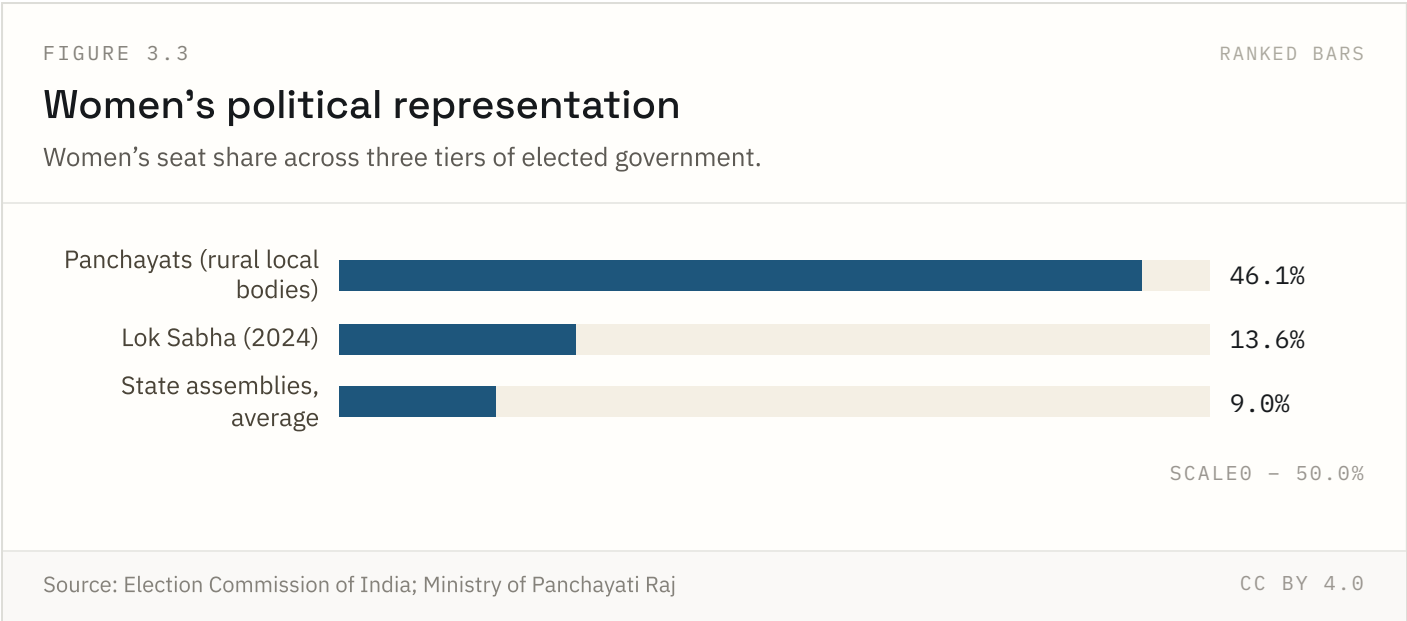
The ratio fell through the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread, bottomed around 2011, and has partially recovered. Recovery is concentrated in Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh — the states where the deficit was worst.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1991-2023 Updated: 21 Jul 2026



The child sex ratio fell in every round from 1961 to 2011, most sharply in the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread. Unlike the sex ratio at birth, it also absorbs excess female mortality in early childhood.

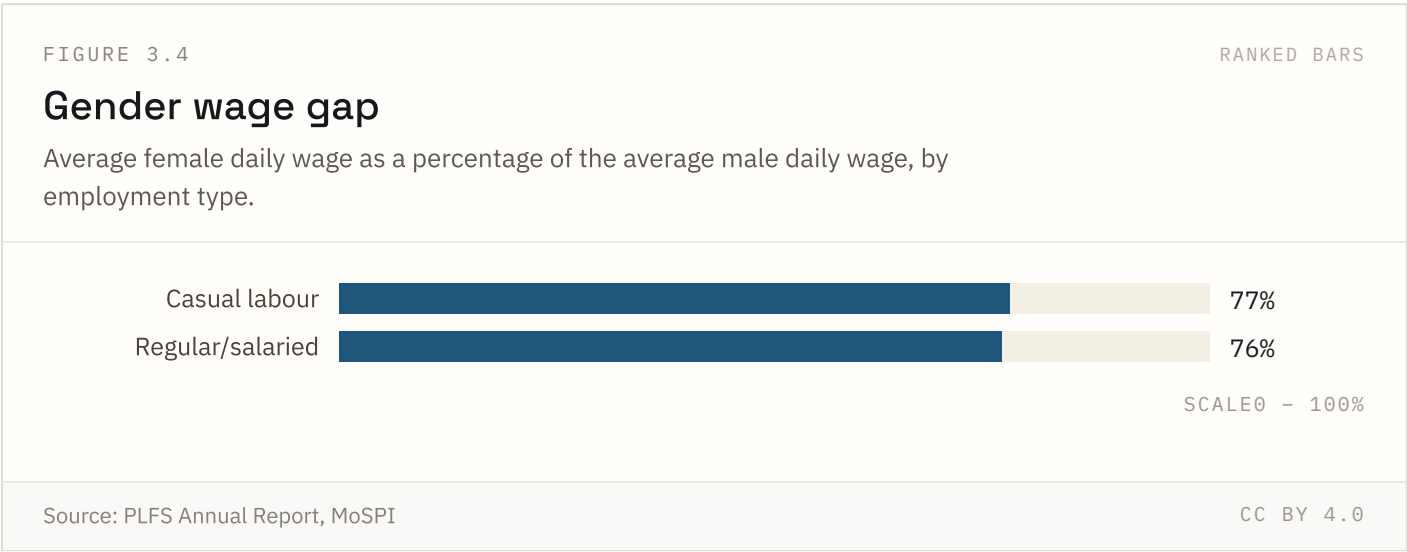
FIGURE 3.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Constitutional reservation (33–50% depending on state) drives the far higher Panchayat figure; no equivalent reservation exists yet for the Lok Sabha or most state assemblies, though a Women’s Reservation Act passed in 2023 is due to apply from the next delimitation.

Source: Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj Coverage: 2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 3.4 NATIONAL ONLY



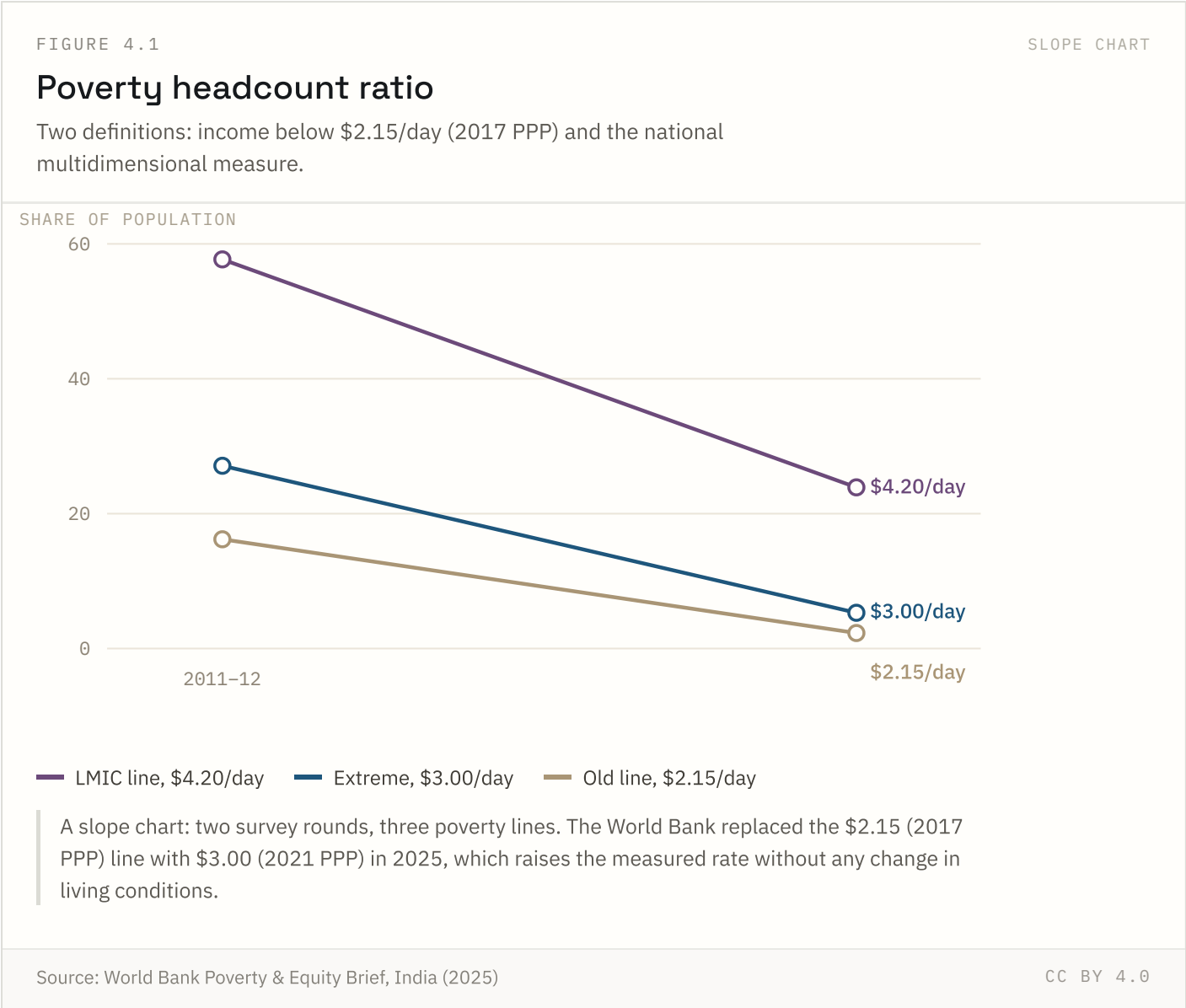
The gap has narrowed slowly over the past decade but persists across both casual and regular/salaried work, even after accounting for differences in sector and hours — unexplained gaps of this kind are consistent with occupational segregation and direct wage discrimination.

Source: PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Poverty & incomes

3 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL + STATE



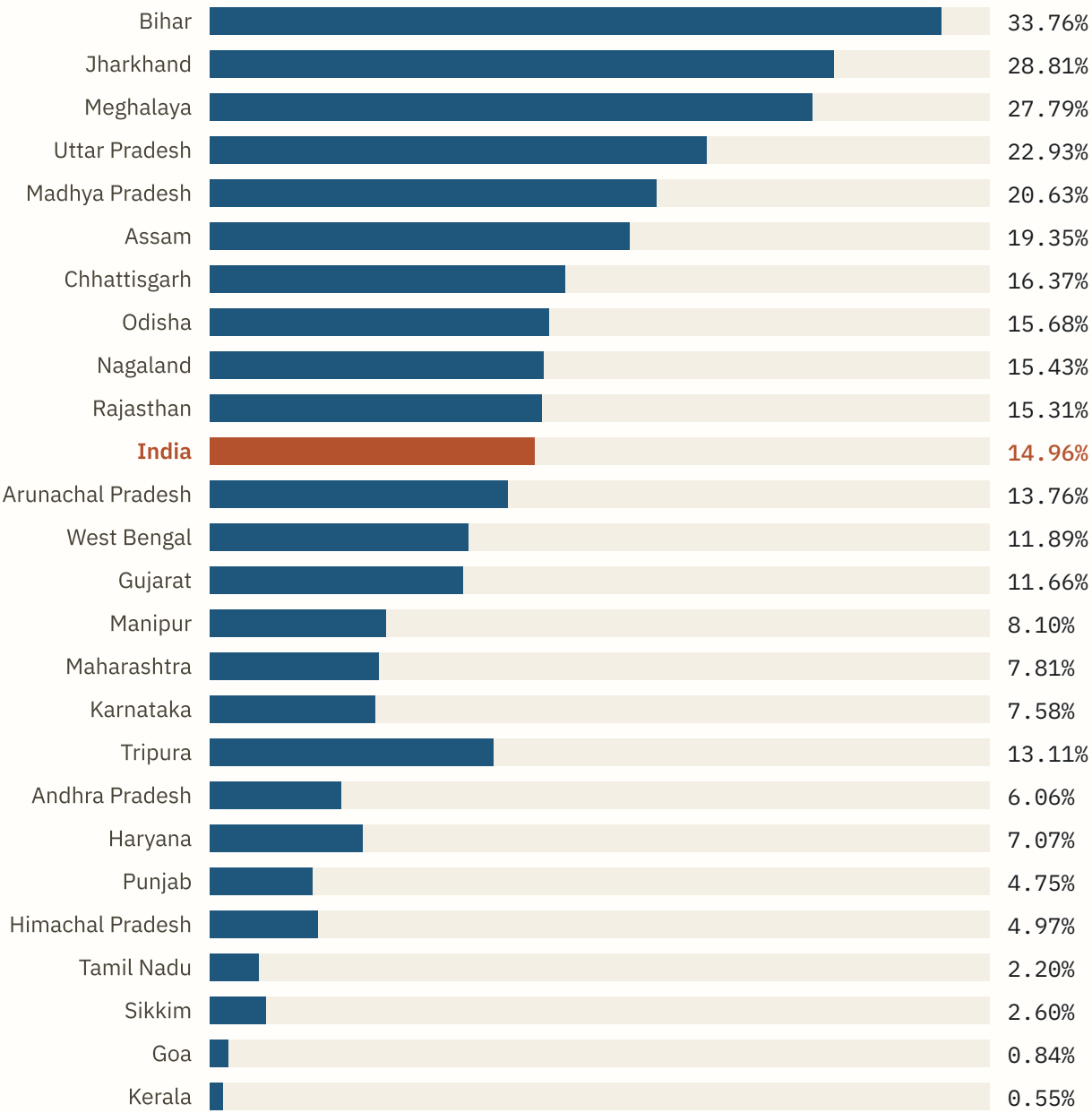
Income poverty and multidimensional poverty answer different questions. The MPI counts deprivations in nutrition, schooling, sanitation, fuel, housing and assets; a household can escape the income line while remaining multidimensionally poor, and often does.

FIGURE 4.2

RANKED BARS

Multidimensional poverty by state

Share of the population identified as multidimensionally poor, NFHS-5 round.



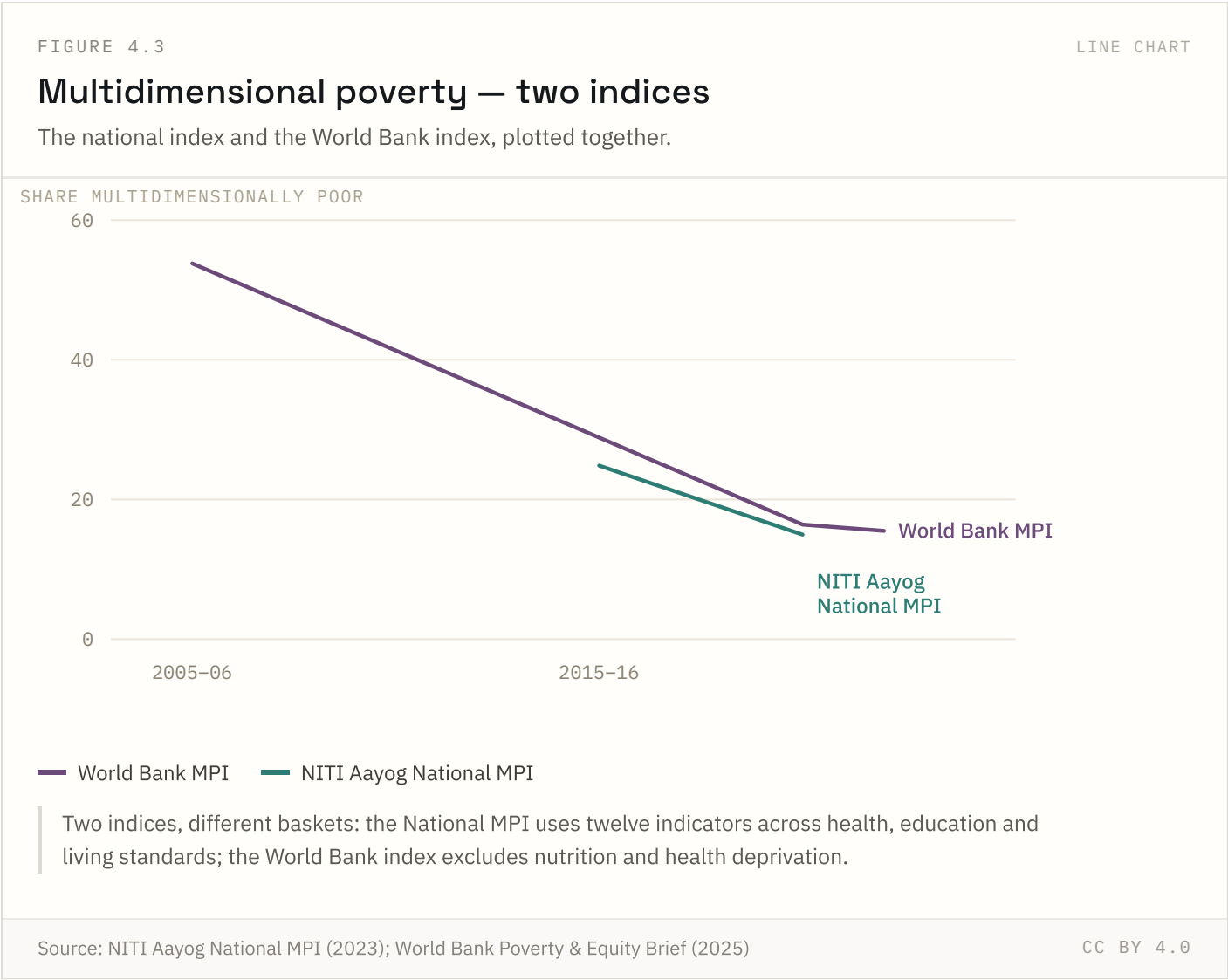
SCALE 0 - 36.00%

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI – A Progress Review 2023

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The National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh together account for roughly half of India’s multidimensionally poor population.

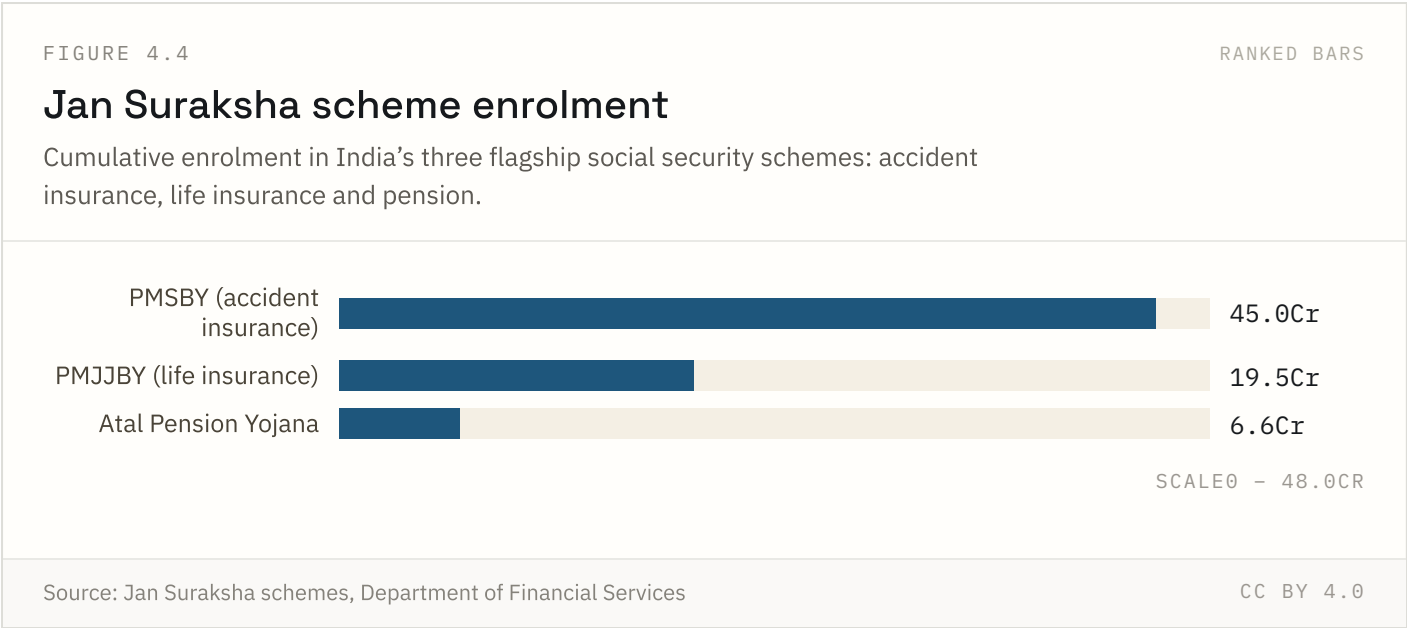
Highest: **Bihar** at 33.76%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 0.55%.



The two indices use different baskets — the National MPI counts twelve indicators including nutrition and maternal health, the World Bank version excludes them — so they should be read as bounds rather than as competing estimates of one quantity.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025) Coverage: 2005-06 to 2022-23

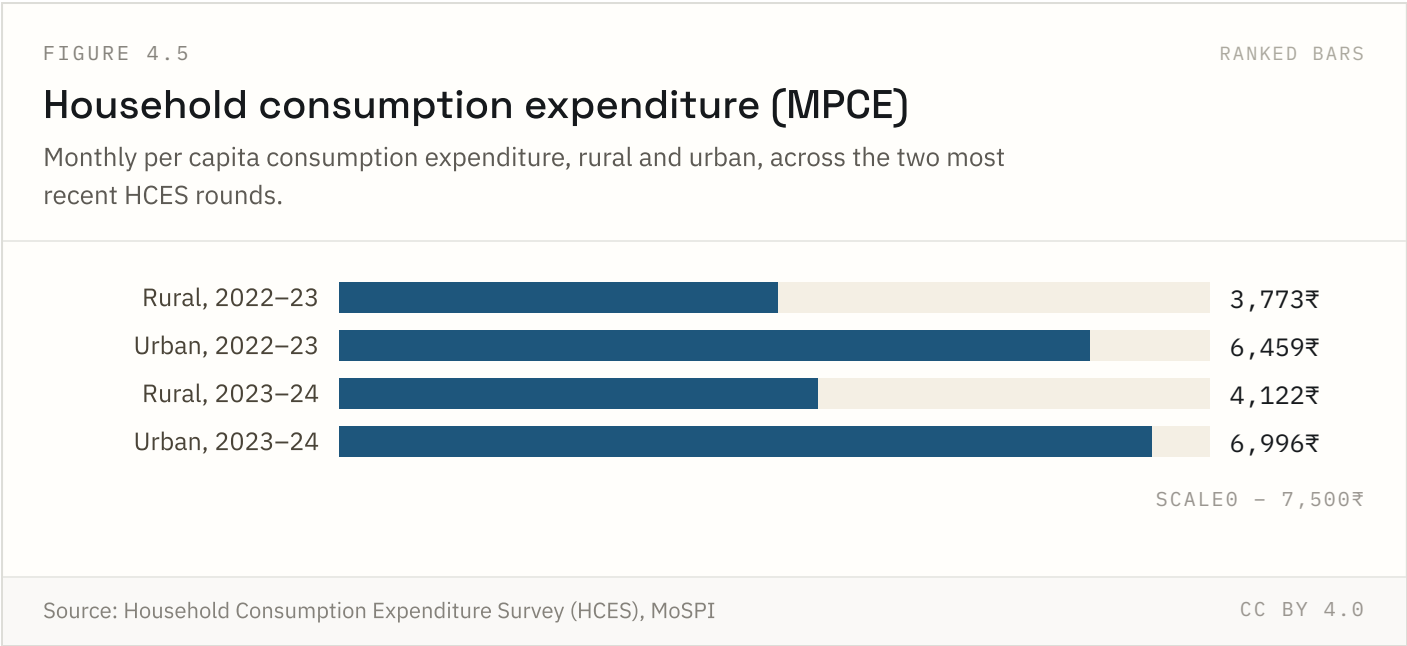
Updated: 24 Jul 2026



PMSBY’s low annual premium (₹20) drives far higher enrolment than the pension scheme, which requires a recurring contribution. Enrolment counts include lapsed and inactive accounts in most published figures, so active coverage is somewhat lower than these cumulative totals suggest.

Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services Coverage: Cumulative to 2024

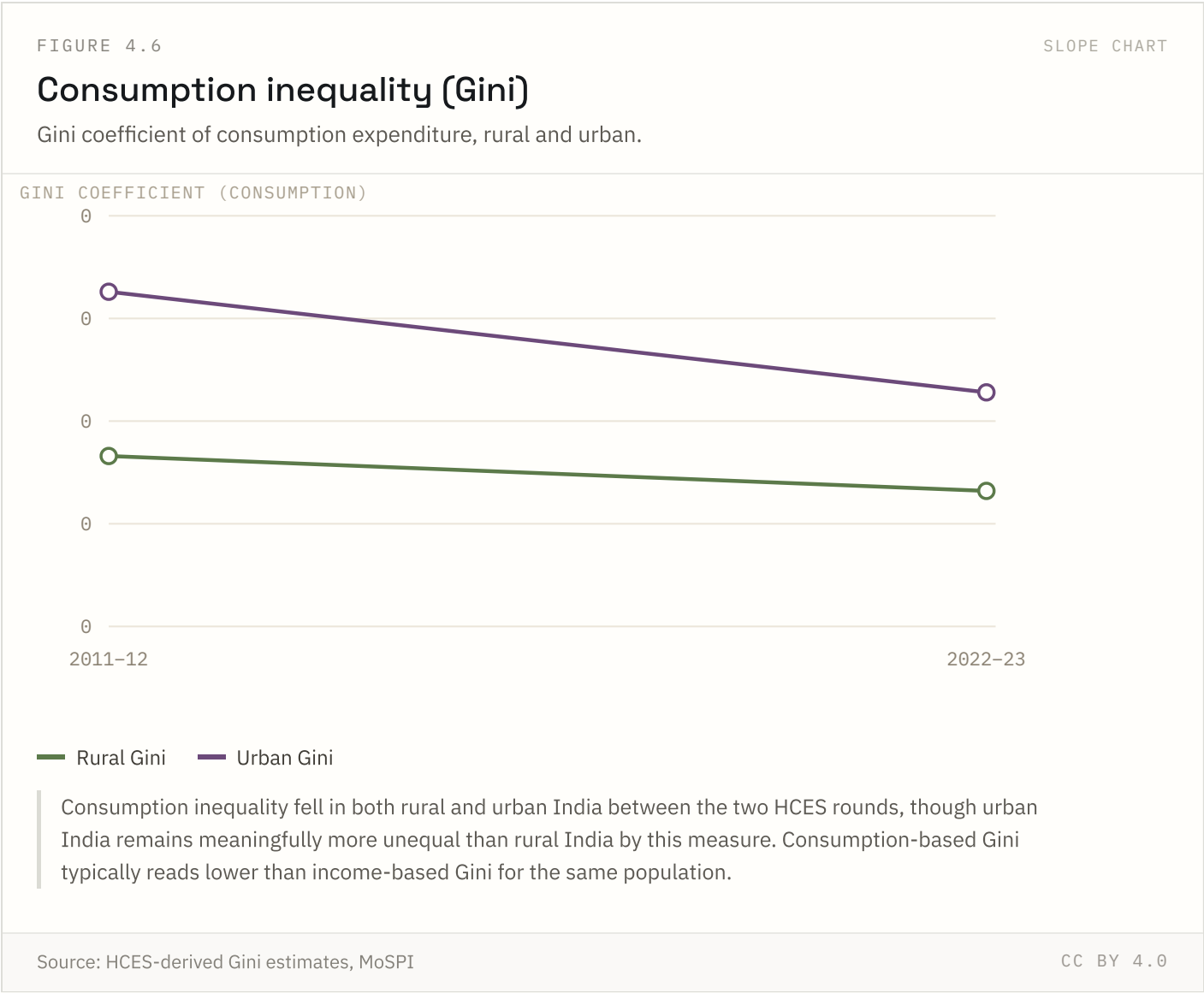
Updated: 18 Aug 2026



MPCE is the bridge between GDP growth and how households actually live — it is the base data used to estimate poverty and inequality. The urban-rural gap (roughly 70%) has narrowed only slightly across the two rounds.

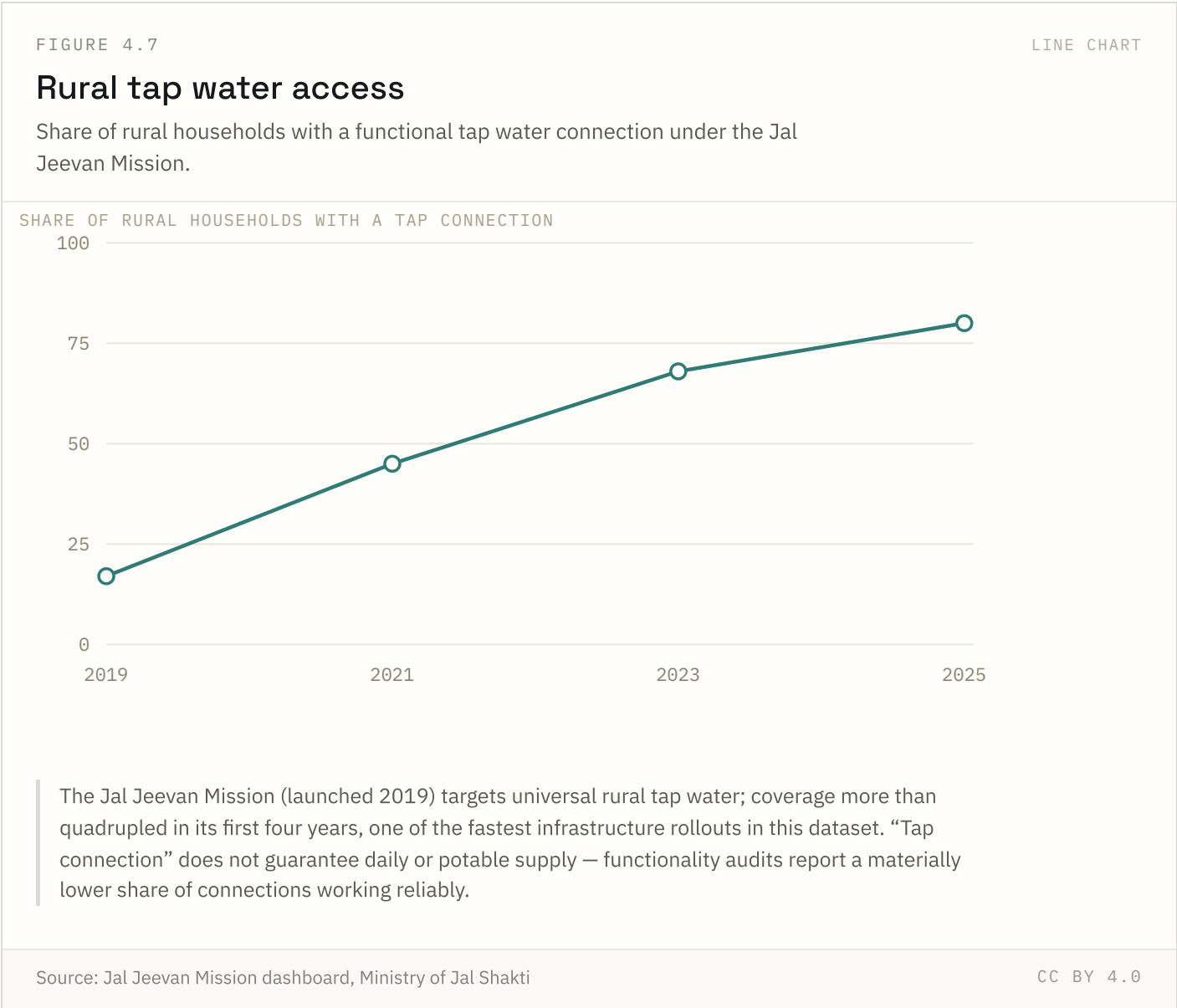
Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI Coverage: 2022-23 to 2023-24

Updated: 18 Aug 2026



Both rural and urban inequality fell between the two survey rounds. Consumption-based Gini is structurally lower than income-based Gini for the same population, since consumption smooths over income volatility — comparisons with countries that report income Gini should account for this.

FIGURE 4.7 NATIONAL ONLY



Coverage rose from under a fifth of rural households in 2019 to roughly four-fifths by 2025, one of the fastest rural infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. A reported connection does not guarantee daily supply or potability — independent functionality audits typically report a lower working share.

Source: Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti Coverage: 2019–2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- **Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 8 of 19 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.
- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

Nothing in this report is projected. Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

References

18 sources used in this report.

1	Census of India, decennial rounds
2	Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj
3	HCES-derived Gini estimates, MoSPI
4	Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI
5	Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti
6	Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services
7	NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India
8	NFHS-3, NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, IIPS
9	NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025)
10	NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023
11	PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI
12	SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI
13	SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI
14	UNDP Human Development Report

15	UNDP Human Development Report, 2020 & 2025 editions
16	World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025)
17	World Happiness Report
18	World Happiness Report, UN SDSN / Gallup / Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre

Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.